MIL-G-3379B
19 May 1975
SUPERSEDING
MIL-G-3379A
24 May 1967

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

GAUZE, ABSORBENT, STERILE, COMPRESSED

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers compressed sterile absorbent gauze suitable for use as a surgical dressing.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

SPECIFICATIONS

Federal

CCC-G-101	Gauze, Absorbent.
PPP-B-566	Boxes, Folding, Paperboard.
PPP-B-636	Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard.
PPP-B-676	Boxes, Setup.

Military

MIL-B-16152	Box, Folding, First Aid Packages.
MIL-S-36586	Sterilization Test Strip Set, Bacterial Spore.

STANDARDS

Military

MIL-STD-105	Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129	Marking for Shipment and Storage.

FSC 6510

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(Copies of specifications, standards, drawings, and publications required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following document forms a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

U.S. Pharmacopeial Convention, Inc.
Pharmacopeia of the United States

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Mack Publishing Company, Easton, PA 18042)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Item requirements. The individual item requirements shall be as specified herein.

3.1.1 Precedence. In the event of conflict between this specification and the APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS (see 2.) the requirements of this specification shall govern.

3.2 Material.

3.2.1 Gauze. The gauze shall conform to Type III of CCC-G-101.

3.2.2 Paper wrapper. The paper wrapper shall be glassine or sulfite paper weighing not less than 25 pounds, basis 24 by 36 inches (500 sheets).

3.3 Construction.

3.3.1 Size. Each piece of gauze shall measure 18 by 36 inches minimum before being folded and compressed.

3.3.2 Folding and Compressing. Each piece of gauze shall be individually folded, with 18 inch long edges on the inside, to a size of 4 inches by 18 inches, and folded again to a size of 4 inches by 9 inches. Raw edges shall be on the inside. This pad shall then be flat folded and compressed in such a manner that two such gauzes shall be capable of fitting the unit carton specified in 5.1.1.1.1. As an alternate to flat folding the pad from the 4 inch by 9 inch size, the pad may be accordion folded from the 4 inch by 18 inch size and then compressed as described herein. There shall be no raw edges exposed.

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3.3.3 Wrapping. Each compressed gauze shall be individually enclosed in a glassine paper wrapper and sealed. The wrapper shall be constructed and sealed so that sterility is maintained until the wrapper is opened. The glassine wrapper shall bear the legend: "STERILE UNLESS WRAPPER IS DAMAGED OR OPENED".

3.4 Sterility. The compressed gauze in the sealed wrapper shall be sterile when tested with a biological indicator as specified in 4.4.2.2. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), steam is the preferred method of sterilization.

3.4.1 Certificate of sterility. A certificate of sterility, stating that samples from each sterilizer lot have been tested and found to be sterile, shall be submitted to the procuring activity. The certificate of sterility shall include:

a. Item identification.
b. National stock number.
c. Contract or purchase order number.
d. Sterility lot or control number.
e. Date of sterilization.
f. Quantity of product in sterilizer lot.
g. Type of sterilization (gas, radiation, heat, steam, etc.).
h. Form of biological indicator (i.e., inoculated paper spore strip or carrier, inoculated product, or inoculated simulated product).
i. Test organism(s) and population density used.
j. Test medium, incubation temperature, incubation time, and dates of tests.
k. Number of test units.
l. Statement that samples comply with sterility tests.
m. Signature of head of laboratory or a designated qualified alternate.

When inspection is made at destination, the certificate of sterility shall be submitted by the contractor to the Directorate of Medical Materiel, ATTN: DPSC-ATQ, Defense Personnel Support Center, 2800 South 20th Street, Philadelphia, PA 19101, and a copy forwarded with each shipment to the consignee. When inspection is made at source, certificate of sterility shall be furnished to the cognizant Government Quality Assurance Representative for submission to the procuring activity.

3.4.1.1 Sterility lot. A sterility lot is that single quantity of product subjected to the same manufacturing operation and simultaneously sterilized in the same sterilizer chamber. Each sterility lot shall be traceable to the pertinent manufacturing lot(s).

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3.5 Workmanship. Workmanship shall be first class throughout. Compressed gauzes shall be free from defects which detract from their appearance or may impair their serviceability.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government, upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of 3 years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

4.1.2 Certificates of quality. Certificates of quality, supplied by the manufacturer of the gauze, may be furnished in lieu of actual performance of such testing by the contractor, provided lot identity has been maintained and can be demonstrated to the Government. The certificate shall include the name of the contractor, the contract number, the name of the manufacturer or supplier, the National Stock Number (NSN), the item identification, the name of the material, the lot number, the lot size, the sample size, the date of testing, the test method, individual test results, and the specification requirements.

4.2 Inspection. Inspection of the gauze shall consist of:

(a) Examination (such as visual, auditory and investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) (see 4.3).
(b) Tests (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) (see 4.4).

4.3 Examination.

4.3.1 Sampling. Sampling for examination shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105 and as indicated in Table I. The unit of product for examination shall be the unit of issue (see 5.1.1).

Table I. Sampling for examination

Type defect	Inspection level	AQL (percent defective)
Major	S-4	1.0
Minor	S-4	2.5

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4.3.2 Examination for defects. The compressed gauze shall be examined for the defects listed in Table II. Examination shall not be restricted to those listed in the Table.

Table II. Classification of defects

Classification	Defects
Major	
101	Folded gauze not sufficiently compressed to fit the specified unit carton.
102	Unit carton does not contain two pieces of gauze, as specified.
103	Gauze not free of holes, cuts, tears or burrs.
104	Gauze not free of lumps, oil spots, dirt, or other foreign material.
105	Gauze not free of excessive fraying, raveling, loose threads or lint.
106	Paper wrapper not free from cuts, holes, tears, open heat seals.
Minor	
201	Dimensions not the minimum specified.
202	Gauze not folded as specified.
203	Labeling or printing on package not legible and free from defacing marks, scratches or tears.

4.4 Tests.

4.4.1 Sampling. Samples shall be selected for tests as required by the applicable referenced specifications or by tests specified herein. When sample size is not specified it shall be at inspection level S-1 of MIL-STD-105, except that the acceptance number shall be zero for all sample sizes, and a minimum of three samples shall be taken regardless of lot size.

4.4.2 Test methods.

4.4.2.1 Gauze. The gauze shall be tested in accordance with CCC-G-101 in order to determine compliance with 3.2.1.

4.4.2.2 Sterility test. The gauze shall be tested for sterility in accordance with the method specified in the Pharmacopeia of the United States (U.S.P.) for purified cotton, gauze, surgical dressings, and related material, using inoculated product, inoculated simulated product, or paper spore strip (carrier). Product containing a biological indicator shall be marked or labeled so that it clearly differentiates from the product intended for distribution. The biological indicator (spore strip) shall be contained in the product, not placed between unit packages. The incubation medium and minimum time in each case shall be soybean casein digest for 7 days for inoculated product, inoculated simulated product, or inoculated carrier (paper spore strip).

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The incubation temperature shall be as indicated in 4.4.2.2.1. The minimum number of test units, regardless of lot size, shall be 10, except for inoculated carrier which shall be 20 for Type I Sterilization and 30 for Type II Sterilization including inoculated carrier and product test units.

4.4.2.2.1 Inoculated product or simulated product. For each type of sterilization, the organism used shall be as listed below:

Type of Sterilization	Organism	Incubation Temperature
Steam	B. stearothermophilus	55° - 65°C
Dry Heat	B. stearothermophilus, or	55° - 65°C
	B. subtilis var. niger (or globigii)	30° - 35°C
Gas	B. subtilis var. niger (or globigii)	30° - 35°C
Radiation	B. pumilus	30° - 35°C

The number of viable cells shall be sufficient to provide assurance that the product has been sterilized.

4.4.2.2.2 Inoculated carrier. Inoculated carriers (paper spore strips) if used shall be in accordance with MIL-S-36586. Other paper carriers shall be inoculated to be of equivalent resistance. The method of incubation and number of test units shall be as indicated in 4.4.2.2 Sterility test and 4.4.2.2.1 inoculated product or simulated product. The method of sterilization shall control the organism in the spore strip to be tested for as shown in 4.4.2.2.1 NOTE: When an inoculated carrier is chosen, product samples shall also be tested as required by the U.S.P.

4.4.2.2.3 Alternate method. Suppliers conducting sterility tests or designating lots in a manner other than that indicated herein shall submit proof that the alternate method provides equal assurance concerning the sterility of the product. However, all sterility tests shall be conducted using biological indicators. Requests for approval of any alternate method of testing for sterility shall be made to the Contracting Officer, and approval obtained before employment of the alternate method on a government contract.

4.4.2.2.4 Product testing. Testing for sterility of the product after receipt by the government shall be without a biological indicator and in accordance with the U.S.P.

4.5 Examination of preparation for delivery. An examination shall be made to determine whether the packaging, packing, and marking comply with the requirements of section 5. Defects shall be scored as specified in Table III. Sampling shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105. The sample unit shall be one container fully prepared for delivery. The lot shall be the number of containers offered for inspection at one time. The inspection level shall be S-2 and the acceptable quality level shall be 4.0 defects per hundred units.

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Table III. Examination of preparation for delivery

Examination	Defect
Containers	Not as specified.
Quantity	Quantity in interior packages and shipping containers not as specified.
Packaging and packing materials	Any component missing or damaged.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components such as incomplete closure of container flaps, tape improperly applied, or containers distorted.
Markings	Omitted, incorrect, illegible, improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be Level A or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Unit of issue. One package containing two (2) individually wrapped gauzes as specified, constitutes one unit of issue.

5.1.1.1 Level A.

5.1.1.1.1 Unit package. Two (2) individually wrapped gauzes shall be packaged in a plastic bag that will protect the contents. Excess air shall be expelled or evacuated from the bag and closure effected by heat sealing. The bag shall form a compact package with finished package dimensions approximately 4 by 2-1/4 by 7/8 inches.

5.1.1.1.2 Intermediate package. One hundred and twenty (120) units of issue shall be packaged in a box of appropriate size and design constructed in accordance with PPP-B-636, Type CF, Class weather resistant. Closure of box shall be in accordance with Method IV of PPP-B-636.

5.1.1.2 Level C. Units shall be packaged in standard commercial containers of the size and kind commonly used, which will afford the degree of protection required for shipment and use of the product for its intended purpose.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be Level A, B or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A. Four hundred and eighty (480) units of issue shall be packed in a box designed for a Type 2 load and constructed in accordance with PPP-B-636, class weather resistant, Grade V3c or V3s. Closure and waterproofing shall be in accordance with the appendix of the box specification.

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5.2.2 Level B. Four hundred and eighty (480) units of issue shall be packed in a box designed for a Type 2 load and constructed in accordance with PPP-B-636, Type CF Class domestic. Closure shall be as specified in the appendix of the box specification.

5.2.3 Level C. The subject commodity shall be packed in substantial commercial containers of the type, size, and kind commonly used for the purpose, so constructed as to insure acceptance and safe delivery by common or other carriers, at the lowest rate, to point of delivery called for in the contract or purchase order.

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 Unit package. Each unit package shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129 and requirements of the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act. Marking shall include the sterility lot (control) number, name and address of manufacturer, contract or purchase order number. Marking shall include the legend: "STERILITY GUARANTEED UNLESS INTERIOR WRAPPER IS DAMAGED OR OPENED." In addition, each unit shall be marked with the method of sterilization (G-Gas, R-Radiation, S-Steam, D-Dry Heat Sterilization). Marking follows the level of packaging and date of packaging. Example: "A-1/75-G". Final sterilization shall be on or after indicated packaging date.

5.3.2 Intermediate package. Each intermediate package shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129. Sterility lot (control) number, contract or purchase order number and name of contractor shall be shown. In addition, the method of sterilization as specified in 5.3.1 shall also be shown.

5.3.3 Exterior container. Exterior container shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129. The sterility lot (control) number and the method of sterilization as specified in 5.3.1 shall also be shown.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The compressed absorbent gauze covered by this specification is intended for use as a dressing on wounds.

6.2 Ordering data. Procurement documents should specify the following:

a. Title, number, and date of this specification.
b. National Stock Number (NSN).
c. Packaging and packing levels (see 5.1 and 5.2).

6.3 This specification is intended to cover the following item appearing in the Federal Supply Catalog:

National Stock Number	Item Identification
6510-00-202-4000	GAUZE, ABSORBENT, 18 x 36 INCHES, 2s

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6.4 Marginal notations. The margins of this specification have not been marked with an asterisk due to the many changes from the previous issue.

Custodians:
Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

Preparing activity:
Defense Supply Agency - DM

Project No. 6510-0604
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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

OMB Approval
No. 22-R255

INSTRUCTIONS: The purpose of this *form* is to solicit beneficial comments which will help achieve procurement of suitable products at reasonable cost and minimum delay, or will otherwise enhance use of the document. DoD contractors, government activities, or manufacturers/ vendors who are prospective suppliers of the product are invited to submit comments to the government. Fold on lines on reverse side, staple in corner, and send to preparing activity. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document(s) or to amend contractual requirements. Attach any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document. If ther are additional papers, attach to form and place both in an envelope addressed to preparing activity.

DOCUMENT IDENTIFIER AND TITLE
MIL-G-3379B GAUZE, ABSORBENT, STERILE, COMPRESSED

NAME OF ORGANIZATION AND ADDRESS

CONTRACT NUMBER

MATERIAL PROCURED UNDER A
☐ DIRECT GOVERNMENT CONTRACT ☐ SUBCONTRACT

1. HAS ANY PART OF THE DOCUMENT CREATED PROBLEMS OR REQUIRED INTERPRETATION IN PROCUREMENT USE?
   A. GIVE PARAGRAPH NUMBER AND WORDING.

   B. RECOMMENDATIONS FOR CORRECTING THE DEFICIENCIES

2. COMMENTS ON ANY DOCUMENT REQUIREMENT CONSIDERED TOO RIGID

3. IS THE DOCUMENT RESTRICTIVE?
   ☐ YES ☐ NO *(If "Yes", in what way?)*

4. REMARKS

SUBMITTED BY *(Printed or typed name and address - Optional)*

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